PROBLEMS OF DISARMAMENT

The United Nations was founded on the belief that peace and security for all peoples would only be possible through disarmament. However, the track record of disarmament efforts is not praiseworthy. Morgenthau[10] points out that success or failure of any particular disarmament effort depends on:

- The ratio among the armaments of different nations.
- The standard according to which, within the ratio, different types and quantities of armaments are to be allocated.
- What is the actual effect in view of intended reduction of the armaments.
- Bearing of disarmament on the issues of international order and peace.

The primary obstacles to disarmament arise from these problems, especially the ones related to the ratios of strength. As there are no fixed ratios among weapons, the questions of standards of allocation of different types and quantities of armaments to be allotted to various nations remain unresolved. Further, the existence of mutual distrust among states frustrates disarmament efforts. National interest and security also make the states cautious on the issues of disarmament and arms control. Political rivalry and disputes also fuel arms race and disarmament commitments break down. Advancement in military R&D and technological innovations induce the states to go on procuring arms and nukes which give rise to proliferation of nuclear weapons and an ensuing nuclear arms race, as was evident during the Cold War between the US and the USSR or as seen between the two South Asian neighbours, India and Pakistan. Besides, the Military Industrial Complex (MIC) also prevents any sort of policy barring the reduction of arms production. The MIC is a lucrative industry in the United States, France, Britain and Russia. The manufacture and sale of weapons is the most profitable business, and unless the MIC is restrained, disarmament measures will not reach its fruition.